Wix: Where to Base a Co-CEO

Updated: 2026-10-26.

BONUS CASE · GOES WITH MODULE 12 · GOAL M12-LG1

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In February 2008, Allon Bloch joined Wix full time as co-CEO and had to decide where to base himself.[1] Wix was a Tel Aviv company with a tool for making websites in Flash without writing code. Its product was still in private beta.[1] [2]

A Tel Aviv company

According to its later filing with the US Securities and Exchange Commission, Wix was incorporated in Israel on 5 October 2006.[3] In October 2007 the blog VC Cafe reported that Wix had a team of 20 in Tel Aviv and had raised a seed round of undisclosed size in August.[2] Users of the private beta could import content from sites such as YouTube, Facebook and Flickr, and Wix turned their creations into widgets that could be published on social networks.[2]

On 8 January 2008, Wix set up a wholly owned subsidiary in the United States. According to its 2013 filing, the subsidiary was by then “engaged primarily in customer support and marketing the Company’s service”.[3] No source gives its activity in early 2008.

The new co-CEO

Bloch had been a general partner at Jerusalem Venture Partners, where he led investments in media companies. He said in May 2008 that he had met Avishai Abrahami, a co-founder of Wix, through a company in the fund’s portfolio, and that he had worked for Wix part-time for a few months before joining full time.[1] Bloch said in May 2008 that Abrahami did “guerilla marketing” and that he himself was “the operational manager”.[1] In the same interview he described the intended users as graphic designers who could not program, small business owners and content creators. He also listed four planned sources of revenue, advertising in the editor, virtual content, partnerships with advertising and media firms, and hosting.[1]

Where to sit

Asked in May 2008 to compare New York with Silicon Valley as a base, Bloch pointed to two things, the time difference with Israel and the location of media companies, with which Wix planned to integrate its software.[1] The sources do not say when he chose a base, where he had lived before, or whether he considered staying in Tel Aviv, where the team worked.

In February 2008, Bloch could join the team in Tel Aviv or work from the United States, where Wix had a weeks-old subsidiary and a product that only beta users could try. In May 2008 he compared two American cities. He had to decide where to sit.

Exhibit 1: Israel and the United States, 2007

Measure, 2007	Israel	United States
Population, millions	7.2	301.2
Internet users per 100 people	48	75
Internet users, millions (case writer's calculation)	3.5	226

Source: World Bank, World Development Indicators, series SP.POP.TOTL and IT.NET.USER.ZS, values for 2007 as published in October 2026, see note 4. Internet users are the case writer's calculation, users per 100 people times population. The World Bank revises its series, so the figures may differ from those published in 2008.

Endnotes

1. Eze Vidra, “Build Flash Sites On The Fly: Interview with Wix Co-CEO Allon Bloch”, VC Cafe, 21 May 2008, https://www.vccafe.com/build-flash-sites-on-the-fly-interview-with-wix-co-ceo-allon-bloch/, accessed 2026-10-26. Bloch’s account, given three months after he joined, is company-reported. Dating of the case. The sources date his full-time start to February 2008 but not his choice of base. The case writer set the decision at his start.
2. Eze Vidra, “Goodbye HTML, Hello Flash – Wix.com Starts The Web-Top Revolution”, VC Cafe, 23 October 2007, https://www.vccafe.com/goodbye-html-hello-flash-wixcom-starts-the-web-top-revolution/, accessed 2026-10-26.
3. Wix.com Ltd., Form F-1 registration statement, filed with the US Securities and Exchange Commission on 1 October 2013, Note 1 to the financial statements, https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/1576789/000119312513387285/d541565df1.htm, accessed 2026-10-26. Written by the company, five years after the events.
4. World Bank, World Development Indicators, SP.POP.TOTL and IT.NET.USER.ZS for Israel and the United States, API data last updated 2026-10-08, https://api.worldbank.org/v2/country/ISR;USA/indicator/SP.POP.TOTL?format=json&date=2007, accessed 2026-10-26. The same URL pattern serves the other series.